I've gone through a lot as a cricketer, managed to deliver decent results under intense pressure. I had a clearer mind, a rediscovered ability to concentrate completely. By focusing solely on the ball, and the conditions, instead of being deflected by self-imposed distractions, I began to enjoy the battle of the game of cricket. It was engrossing, fulfilling.

That doesn't mean to say Bawds and I agreed on everything. His insistence that it didn't matter whether I got 0, 10 or 100, so long as I had followed The Plan, was a step too far. In his world, I can take off my pads having made 3 and be satisfied. In my world, if I score 3, or something similarly underwhelming, ten times on the trot, I haven't got a job.

It is all very well trusting the process, but results matter. It is a numbers game, and that involves delivering for the team. I understand the concept of the scorebook not telling the full story, but reality is telling me something entirely different. Once the umpire gives me out the circumstances are irrelevant. I'm out. It is how I deal with results that is most important.

I appreciated the underlying strategy, of attempting to reduce fluctuations in form. We all ride the wave scoring runs; the better players crash off, climb back on, and re-establish themselves quickly on the next wave. I knew what Bawds was getting at when he tried to draw a distinction between a hundred in which I'd played relatively poorly, being dropped four times, and a fluid twenty, when I was beaten by a brilliant delivery, but I spoke from experience.

I used my 105 against Pakistan at Lord's in 2006, in my first Test in England, as a reference point. I was dropped twice, the first time on 0, by Imran Farhat. Danish Kaneria spilled a simple return catch. Umpire Steve Bucknor failed to detect a thin edge off the spinner when I had made 43; there was no DRS and walking wasn't in the playbook.

Those escapes, lucky or not, ultimately didn't matter. Having three figures against my name helped me, as a young player, to feel I belonged. I wasn't very accessible in those days. Even such a lovely guy as Marcus Trescothick, who opened with Michael Vaughan in that Test, mentioned to me, 'You don't do pleasantries very well, do you?'

I'm not that bothered about pleasantries in my cricket. I've always been single-minded, driven by doing things my own way. I shared my deepest thoughts with Bawds in 2010 because I trusted him. He wasn't what I'd call a tick-the-box psychologist. He wasn't giving me cliché after cliché. He really understood where I wanted to be and how to get there.